political alienation: a desperate attempt to plaster over existential anxieties that ranged from colonial oppression to unemployment and food scarcity. With constitutional reforms bringing more and more Indians into the realm of electoral politics, Jinnah and Nehru's contradictory ideas of India clashed soon after their joint appearance in Lucknow.

IN THE 1937 provincial elections, the Indian National Congress secured a resounding victory. At the polls of India's first large-scale election campaign that departed from the established system of dyarchy and increased the vote to thirty-six million Indians, including some women, the Indian National Congress secured more than 750 of some 1,500 seats. This sweeping success did more than underline the Congress's claim of being a national party. It altogether transformed the Congress from a mass movement to a political party. Congress members now occupied ministries in five provinces outright and constituted coalition governments in another two.

Jinnah suffered a crushing defeat. His All-India Muslim League secured less than 5 per cent of the Muslim vote, although this slim vote share amounted to some 108 seats from 485 reserved for Muslims under the Communal Award. Jinnah had failed to move voters in Punjab and Bengal with his plea that Indian Muslims had to stand under the political flag of a single party and scored seats primarily in Muslim-minority areas. In Bengal, Muslim voters flocked to the local Krishak Praja Party, and in Punjab, they resorted to Sikandar Hayat Khan's Unionist Party in droves. Both the Muslim League and the Congress had failed to make significant inroads to Muslim voters.

With a comfortable electoral majority in tow, Nehru departed from his promised agitational stance towards the 1935 Act and began working with the British Government. He also attempted to liquidate the Muslim League. When League members approached the Congress to constitute a coalition government in the United Provinces, Nehru snubbed their attempts and